grounding any sense of demographic vulnerability.[24] Situating this sense of threat globally, however, also enables an indexical relationship in which all Muslims in Myanmar are potentially interchangeable with ISIS and images of ISIS are potentially interchangeable with Myanmar Muslims. This is the relationship by which beholding ISIS is to confirm the violent potential in Islam, and encountering a Muslim in Myanmar is to behold the potential for ISIS-like violence.

The state in Myanmar has repeatedly and explicitly made the argument that some Muslims in Myanmar are also extremists, in the rhetoric of senior officials and through allegations and arrests of purported "terrorists" and Muslim extremist groups (Galache 2015; Murdoch 2015). But in examining the uses of strands of argument from outside Myanmar, we can see the full expanse of this narrative: it says not that there may be *some* Muslims who are *also* extremists but that *all* Muslims always already satisfy the conditions necessary for (potential) extremism. This is an example of an important shift that Veena Das described in her exploration of Hindu–Sikh violence in India: when "*fear of the other* is transformed into the notion that *the other is fearsome*" (1998, p. 125, emphasis in original). In Myanmar, the strands of argument that make reference to global Islam help to construct the boundaries for marking a fearsome Other that is defined along religious lines. During our listening project, narrators described how news of violence by Muslims elsewhere prompted them to direct their gaze towards individual Muslims with uncertainty and concern. In the following excerpt from an interview with a young woman in Mawlamyine, for example, she makes explicit the interchangeable relationship between fears generated by views of ISIS and of Muslims in Myanmar:

> A: According to [what I hear from] other people, I am worried that ISIS will affect us, and in our country we have many Muslims. When I see they [ISIS] cut people's heads off, it will be a problem if this comes to us. Some of my friends tell me, if they see Muslims, they are scared of them even though they might not have [plans of cutting people's heads off] in their mind. It is like seeing the news about that and then having fear when looking at these people [Muslims in Myanmar].
>
> Q: You mention, you are feeling scared, when did you start to feel like that?
>
> A: It happened after seeing that news and the Rakhine problem. Since then the news always pops up about it. I am worried that ISIS's actions will affect the world or will affect our country …